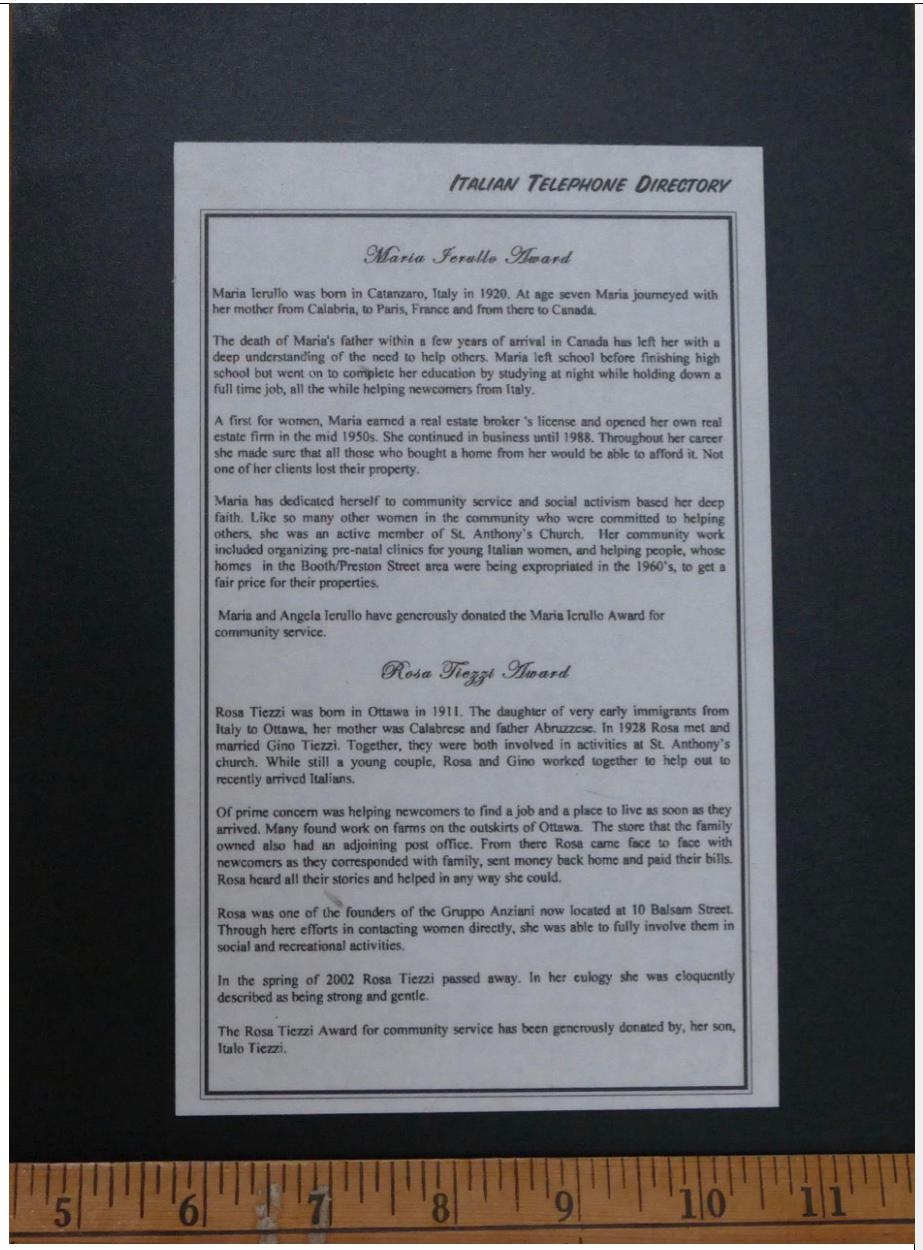
Page from the 2014 Italian Telephone Directory of Ottawa giving a brief outline of her life in conjunction with the award sponsored by Maria and Angela Ierullo at the Ottawa Italian Canadian Women's Filò			

ITALIAN TELEPHONE DIRECTORY

Maria Ierullo Award

Maria Ierullo was born in Catanzaro, Italy in 1920. At age seven Maria journeyed with her mother from Calabria, to Paris, France and from there to Canada.

The death of Maria's father within a few years of arrival in Canada has left her with a deep understanding of the need to help others. Maria left school before finishing high school but went on to complete her education by studying at night while holding down a full time job, all the while helping newcomers from Italy.

A first for women, Maria earned a real estate broker 's license and opened her own real estate firm in the mid 1950s. She continued in business until 1988. Throughout her career she made sure that all those who bought a home from her would be able to afford it. Not one of her clients lost their property.

Maria has dedicated herself to community service and social activism based her deep faith. Like so many other women in the community who were committed to helping others, she was an active member of St. Anthony's Church. Her community work included organizing pre-natal clinics for young Italian women, and helping people, whose homes in the Booth/Preston Street area were being expropriated in the 1960's, to get a fair price for their properties.

Maria and Angela Ierullo have generously donated the Maria Ierullo Award for community service.

Rosa Tiezzi Award

Rosa Tiezzi was born in Ottawa in 1911. The daughter of very early immigrants from Italy to Ottawa, her mother was Calabrese and father Abruzzese. In 1928 Rosa met and married Gino Tiezzi. Together, they were both involved in activities at St. Anthony's church. While still a young couple, Rosa and Gino worked together to help out to recently arrived Italians.

Of prime concern was helping newcomers to find a job and a place to live as soon as they arrived. Many found work on farms on the outskirts of Ottawa. The store that the family owned also had an adjoining post office. From there Rosa came face to face with newcomers as they corresponded with family, sent money back home and paid their bills. Rosa heard all their stories and helped in any way she could.

Rosa was one of the founders of the Gruppo Anziani now located at 10 Balsam Street. Through here efforts in contacting women directly, she was able to fully involve them in social and recreational activities.

In the spring of 2002 Rosa Tiezzi passed away. In her eulogy she was eloquently described as being strong and gentle.

The Rosa Tiezzi Award for community service has been generously donated by, her son, Italo Tiezzi.